

■ resolve~s.o.s.

If you do not have a rescue disk, you could resolve the problem by manually rebuilding the MBR and the BIOS Parameter Block. You might need the help of your local computer technician for this.

Hardware

+ Video moods

When I click on the capture card to play TV on my computer, the following message is displayed: 'Current VGA display mode not suitable for video overlay. Video quality will be degraded. Please install Direct Draw driver and change to high colour or above mode.' Please suggest ways to solve this problem.

Bharat

Via e-mail

R There could be several reasons for getting this message. You could try the following troubleshooting tips:

1. Use the latest DirectX and TV card drivers. Outdated, or corrupt drivers can result in errors or poor performance.

2. Try running the PC-TV card in a 16-bit, high colour mode. If this gives you problems, run it in the lowest graphics mode, that is, 8-bit, 256 colours, and check if the images are visible, even though they maybe of poor quality. You could then start increasing the mode to find out which setting gives you a good quality, without any error messages. Also, don't shift video modes (colour bit, refresh rates and video resolutions) while the PC-TV card is in use. The change in the video drivers can crash the system.

3. You could also use moderate video resolutions and refresh rates, and disable power management features such as screen savers, etc, to avoid such problems.

4. Another thing to check is whether you are getting a strong and clean TV signal. Make sure that you are using good quality cabling. Poor cabling and connectors can easily degrade even strong video signals. Check that all your video and audio cables are secure.

Windows

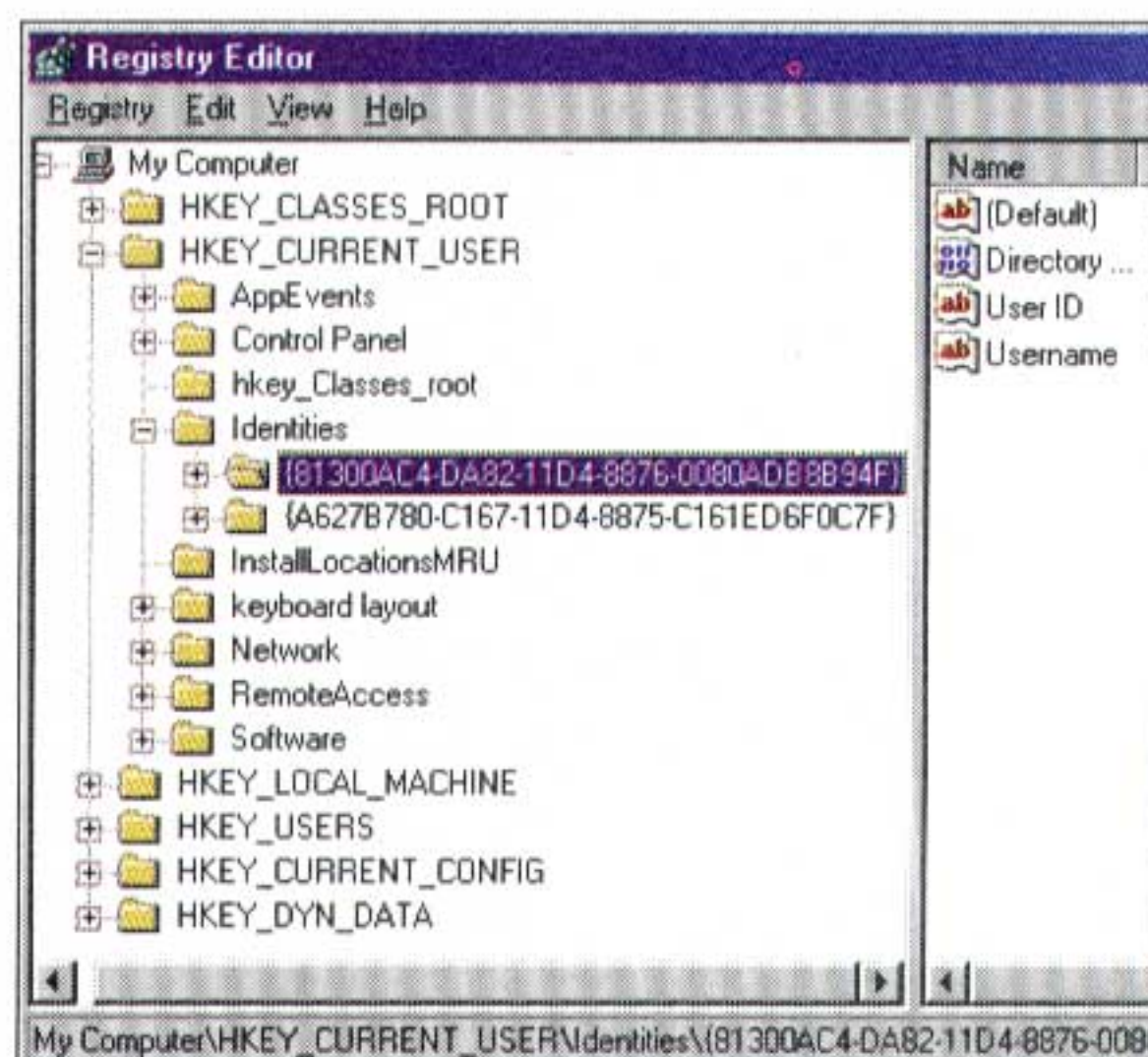
+ Identity Crisis

When I start Outlook Express, version 5, I get the following error: 'Identity switch cancelled. The current identity could not be changed because one of the applications was unable to switch'. How do I fix this?

Vinay

Via e-mail

R This problem occurs when a particular entry in the registry is either damaged or is missing. You will have to edit the registry to fix the problem. Make sure you take a backup of the registry before attempting to make changes to it. Go to **Start > Run**. Type **Regedit** and click OK. Navigate to the following key, **HKEY_CURRENT_USER \Identities**. Double-click on **Identities**. The keys under **Identities**, in the left pane, are the account identities. Click on **Account ID** and make sure that a string value with the name, **User ID**, exists in the right pane, and it has the same value as that of the **Account**



Fixing identity problems in Outlook Express

ID. If you have more than one **Account ID**, check for all of these. If necessary, delete and recreate the string, 'User ID'.

Windows

+ Win Me setup error

I get this peculiar error when I run the setup of Win Me: 'Setup must be able to create short file-names with numeric tails for files with names longer than 8 characters. Enable this option and try running Setup again.' I don't know what is the problem. I used to get the same error when I used to run setup for Win 98.

Jayesh

Via e-mail

R This error message may occur when you upgrade from Windows 95 to

Windows 98, or from Windows 98 to Windows Me, because of the presence of a particular string value in the registry. This removes the tilde (~) from the long file names.

As an example, the **My Documents'** long file name, **mydocu~1**, would be renamed to **mydocume**. This creates problems in the installation. To fix the problem,

go to **Start > Run**. Type **regedit**, and click OK. Navigate to the following key, **HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\System\CurrentControlSet\Control\FileSystem** and delete the **NameNumericTail** string value. Restart the PC, and re-run Setup.

Another way to fix this problem, if it occurs while upgrading to Windows Me, is present in the Windows Me CD itself. If you run the installer, **Nnt.inf**, in the **\tools\pssutil** directory, it will do this registry editing.

Internet & Communications

+ Invalid page fault

I am facing a problem with IE 5. I get the following message after some pages open up and am forced to close IE: 'IEXPLORE caused an invalid page fault in module CRS32.DLL'. I've also tried running **sfc.exe**, but in vain. Please help.

Kirit Modi

Via e-mail

R The System File Checker checks only for the files needed by the system. The **CRS32.dll** is not a file that is needed by the system or a file that gets installed by default.

The **CRS32.dll** and **crs.exe** seem to be installed by some third-party software, which might be games or advertising software programs, or by spyware.

To get rid of the problem, you will have to manually find and delete all instances of the files, **crs.exe** and **crs32.dll**, from your PC. First boot your PC in Safe mode to ensure that these programs are not working in the background.

Then, using the Find utility in Windows, search and delete them. Next, boot the PC normally and go to **Start > Run**.

Type **regedit** and click OK. You should search for entries to the above files in the registry and delete them. If unsure, you could also rename them to something like **crs32.old**. Remember to make a backup of your registry before you make any changes.

Then select **Edit > Find** and search for **CRS**. Delete entries that use **CRS32.dll** and **CRS.exe**. As an alternative, if you know that the error has occurred after installing a particular program, logon to the Web site of that program provider, and browse through their support page for any mention of this error. ■

DO YOU NEED HELP?

Send an SOS to sos@jasubhai.com

Or write in to DIGIT, D-222/2, Om Sagar Bldg, MIDC, Nerul-400 706